



THE GOOD LIFE

TRENDS

POLAR EXPRESS

A NEW WAVE OF INDIAN EXPLORERS IS TRADING TROPICAL GETAWAYS FOR ICE-BOUND ADVENTURES AT THE ENDS OF THE EARTH

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

I**N MID-FEBRUARY**, when Gurugram-based luxury travel company Away & Co began promoting its Antarctica journey across social media, WhatsApp groups, and its private client network, the team expected curiosity. What they did not expect was demand. Within weeks, more than 150 enquiries had come in for the journey, priced at \$19,995 per

person for a seven-night, eight-day trip. It revealed something significant: for a growing number of Indian travellers, the ultimate luxury is no longer the presidential suite in Paris or a private island in the Maldives, but the vast white landscapes of Antarctica and the Arctic.

The polar regions, once the domain of scientists and explorers, are now emerging as one of the

most aspirational travel experiences for Indian travellers.

EXPERIENTIAL TRAVEL

According to Ruchi Kohli, Chief of Experiences at Away & Co, the growing interest in polar travel reflects a deeper change in travel philosophy rather than a passing trend. “Polar travel has moved from being a curiosity to a considered travel option and we are seeing a much stronger intent, a much